

► KOBOSHI KABUTO

Date 15th–16th century

Origin Japan

Material Iron, copper gilt, leather, silk, lacquer

High-sided, multi-studded helmets in the style known as *koboshi kabuto* could contain as many as 2,000 rivets. It was quite common for a good helmet bowl to be recycled: this one was refurbished with a new neck guard, visor, and crest ornaments, for a member of the Honda family.



► YUMI

Date 19th century

Origin Japan

Weight 220g (7¾oz)

Length 1.36m (4½ft)

The design of the *yumi* (Japanese bow) has been unchanged since at least 1000CE. It was built with bamboo glued to the back and front. The grip was positioned near the lower end to allow the bow to be used on horseback.



▲ TANTO BLADE

Date 1400

Origin Japan

Weight 145g (5oz)

Length 21.8cm (8½in)

Daggers were thrust through a sash on the left-hand side when wearing armour. The *tanto* (dagger) blade was acutely pointed and sturdy, designed to pierce armour when opponents were engaged in hand-to-hand combat.

► IRON CANNON

Date c.1400

Origin China

Length 47cm (18½in)

Bore 10cm

This small cannon was fired from a trestle-like stand. It was cast with a bulbous breech region to resist pressure. Rather than firing a single projectile, it was loaded with a number of smaller missiles.



▲ JIAN

Date Early 15th century

Origin China

Weight 1.3kg (2¾lb)

Length 90.3cm (35½in)

The *jian* (Chinese straight sword) was the favoured weapon of figures in both Taoist and Buddhist mythology. This sword, with a richly decorated hilt and scabbard, was made for presentation to a Tibetan monastery.



▲ YA NO NE

Date 18th century

Origin Japan

Weight 20–40g (¾–1½oz)

Length 18–24cm (7–9½in)

Japanese archers used many shapes of *ya no ne* (arrowheads). These examples are forked heads called *karimata* because of their resemblance to a skein of geese. They have a long tang to fit into the bamboo shaft.

▼ TACHI

Date 18th century

Origin Japan

Weight 130g (4½oz)

Length 74.5cm (29¼in)

The *tachi* was a long sword worn slung from the belt, attached by the *sageo* (cord) on its scabbard. The *tachi* was superseded by the *katana* for civilian wear by samurai, but remained the proper weapon to be worn with armour.

Rattan binding to prevent joints weakening from damp

